

Social Media Marketing

Strategy, platforms, community and organic growth
for businesses in Mauritius, step by step

Avinesh Bundhoo & Fareez Fawdar · Oreegami Mauritius · October 2026



Inside this guide

- 1 What social media marketing is
- 2 How algorithms work
- 3 Social media in Mauritius
- 4 The social media strategy
- 5 Choosing your platforms
- 6 The social media audit
- 7 Benchmarking and listening
- 8 Optimising profiles
- 9 Facebook
- 10 Instagram
- 11 TikTok
- 12 LinkedIn
- 13 YouTube
- 14 WhatsApp for business
- 15 Other platforms
- 16 Organic growth
- 17 Community management
- 18 Customer service
- 19 Negative comments and crises
- 20 Groups and communities
- 21 Creators and advocacy
- 22 From social to sales
- 23 Scheduling tools
- 24 Social media analytics
- 25 Monthly report
- 26 Governance and security
- 27 A first look at paid social
- 28 Case study: a gym
- 29 Exercises and Social Playbook
- 30 Checklists and glossary

PART A

Foundations

What social media does for a business, how algorithms work and the Mauritian landscape

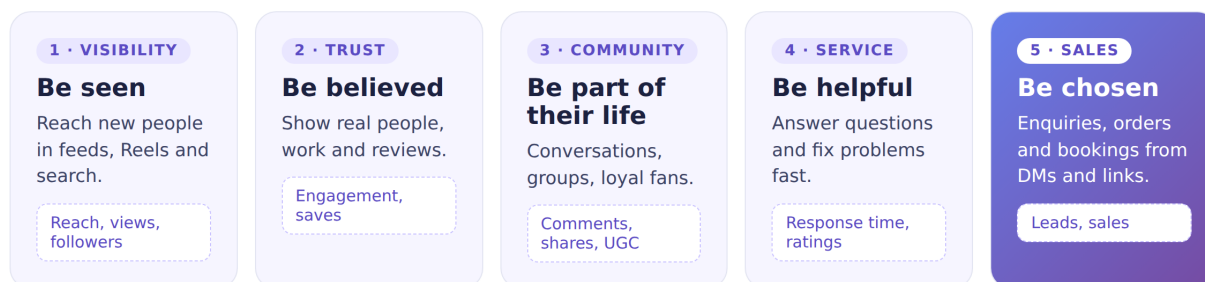
SECTION 1

What social media marketing is

Social media marketing means using platforms such as Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, LinkedIn, YouTube and WhatsApp to reach people, build relationships and grow a business. It includes what you publish (organic content), how you talk with people (community management) and what you pay to promote (social ads, Weeks 8–9).

Five jobs social media does for a business

Most businesses only use the first one



Organic vs paid social

	Organic social	Paid social
What it is	Posts, reels, stories, replies and groups you publish for free	Ads and boosted posts you pay for
Reach	Your followers plus people the algorithm recommends you to	Exactly the audience you target
Speed	Builds over time	Immediate
Strength	Trust, community, loyalty, customer service	Scale, precision, fast results
Weakness	Unpredictable reach	Stops when the budget stops
This week	The focus	Introduced in Section 27; full detail in Weeks 8–9

Week 4 (content marketing) taught you how to plan and create content. This week focuses on the **social platforms themselves**: choosing them, setting them up properly, understanding how each one works, managing your community and growing organically.

Common mistakes businesses make

- Being on every platform, with old, inactive pages that make the business look closed.
- Posting only promotions and never replying to comments or messages.
- Treating social media as a noticeboard instead of a conversation.
- Personal accounts used as business pages (no insights, no ads, against platform rules).
- One person holds all the passwords; when they leave, the business loses its page.
- Measuring success only by followers and likes.

The mindset: social media is not a channel you broadcast on, it is a place where your customers already spend time. Behave like a good neighbour: be useful, be present, listen and reply.

SECTION 2

How algorithms work

An algorithm is the system that decides which posts each person sees, and in which order. On every major platform, most content people see is now chosen by the algorithm, including posts from accounts they don't follow (recommendations).

How social media algorithms decide what people see

Every platform is different, but they all follow the same logic

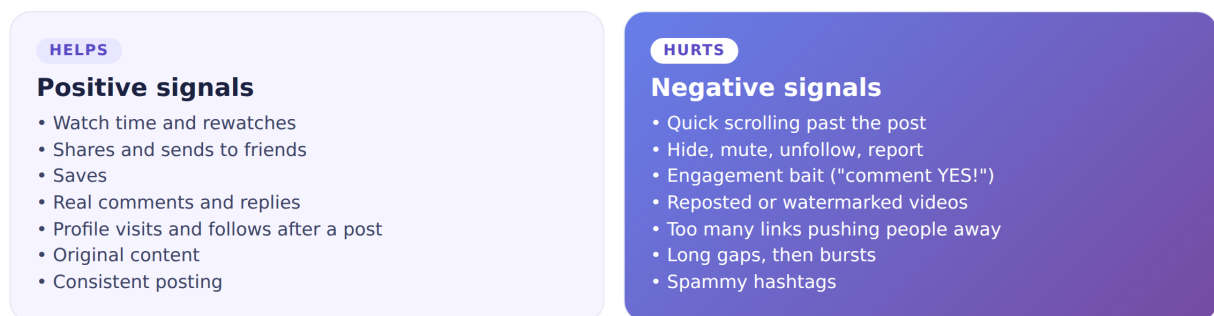


What the platforms are trying to do

Each platform wants people to stay longer and come back often. So the algorithm shows each person the content it predicts they will enjoy most. Your job is not to "trick" the algorithm, but to create content that the right people genuinely want to watch, share and talk about.

Signals that help or hurt your reach

What platforms reward and punish in 2026



How a new post gets distributed

1. The post is shown to a small group: some of your followers and, on TikTok and Reels, people interested in the topic.
2. The platform watches the reaction: do people stop, watch to the end, share, save, comment?
3. If the reaction is strong, it shows the post to a larger group, then larger again.

4. If people scroll past or hide it, distribution slows down.

That is why the first hour and the first day matter, and why the first seconds of a video and the first line of a caption are so important. On LinkedIn, a large share of interactions happens within the first day of publishing.

Platform differences at a glance

Platform	Biggest signals	Discovery source
Facebook	Meaningful comments, shares, watch time; quality of comments now assessed	Friends, followed pages, groups and recommended Reels
Instagram	Sends (shares), watch time, saves; originality	Followers (feed, stories) and non-followers (Reels, Explore)
TikTok	Completion rate, rewatches, shares, interests	Mostly interest-based "For You" feed, plus search
LinkedIn	Dwell time, conversations in comments, topic expertise	Network, followers and topic interest
YouTube	Click-through on thumbnails, watch time, satisfaction	Search, recommendations, Shorts feed

Tip: engagement bait ("Comment YES if you agree!", "Tag 10 friends!") is detected and pushed down by Facebook and other platforms. Ask genuine questions instead.

SECTION 3

Social media in Mauritius

Mauritius is a small but highly connected market. Understanding who uses which platform, in which language and at what time helps you focus your energy.

Indicator	Figure (DataReportal Digital 2026)
Population	About 1.27 million
Internet users	About 1.01 million (79.5%)
Social media user identities	About 886,000 (69.9% of the population, +5.3% in a year)
Facebook ad reach	886,000 (69.9%)
Messenger ad reach	599,000 (47.2%)
LinkedIn members	630,000 (+16.7% in a year)
Instagram ad reach	418,000 (33.0%, +9.2%)
X (Twitter) ad reach	210,000 (16.6%)

Advertising reach estimates are not the same as active users, and "user identities" are not unique people. Use them to compare platforms, not as exact audience sizes. TikTok and YouTube don't publish comparable local figures.

What this means for your business

- **Facebook is the backbone** for most consumer businesses, especially for audiences above 30, local communities and events.
- **Instagram matters** for visual businesses (food, fashion, beauty, tourism, events) and younger audiences.
- **TikTok** is where many under-35s discover entertainment, food spots and trends; it rewards personality over polish.

- **LinkedIn** is essential for B2B, training, recruitment and professional services, and growing fast.
- **WhatsApp** is where conversations and orders happen. Almost every customer journey ends in a WhatsApp chat.
- **Google Business Profile** is not a social network, but its posts, photos and reviews work like one for local businesses (Week 3).

In Mauritius: the market is small, so you will rarely have huge follower numbers. A Rose Hill bakery with 4,000 engaged local followers can be far more valuable than an account with 50,000 followers abroad. Focus on the right people, not the biggest numbers.

Social media trends to know in 2026

Trend	What it means for you
Recommendation feeds	Most of what people see comes from accounts they don't follow. Every post can reach new people if it is good, and followers alone don't guarantee reach.
Private sharing (DMs)	People share posts privately with friends and family. "Sends" are now a top signal: create content worth forwarding.
Social search	TikTok, Instagram and YouTube are used like search engines; public Instagram posts from professional accounts can also appear on Google.
Originality rules	Platforms reduce reach for reposted or watermarked content and reward original creators.
People over logos	Faces, founders, staff and creators get more trust and engagement than brand graphics.
AI labels and AI tools	Platforms label realistic AI content and offer AI editing tools; authenticity matters more than ever.
Messaging as a sales channel	Conversations move to WhatsApp, Messenger and Instagram DMs, often from a Reel or a story.

When people are online

Typical activity peaks are early morning (commute and breakfast), lunchtime and the evening (about 19:00–21:30), with different patterns at weekends. These are only starting points: your own insights in Meta Business Suite, TikTok and LinkedIn show when **your** audience is online.

PART B

Strategy

Goals, platforms, audits,
benchmarking and profiles

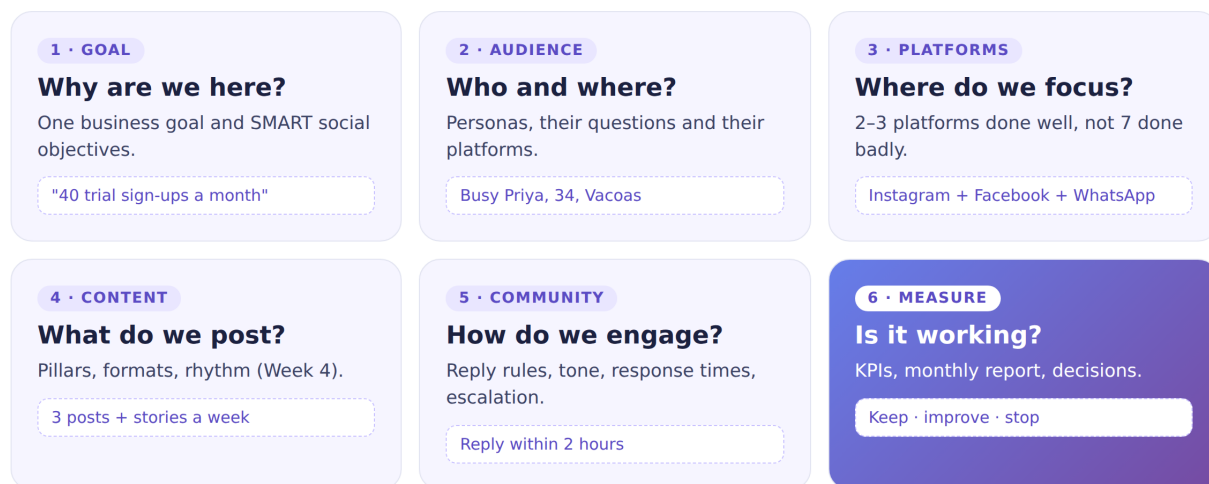
SECTION 4

The social media strategy

A social media strategy explains what you want to achieve on social media, for whom, on which platforms, with what content and community approach, and how you will measure it. It fits on two pages and guides every post and reply.

The social media strategy in six steps

From business goal to monthly review



SMART social media objectives

Business goal	Social media objective (SMART)	Main KPI
More trial members for a gym	40 trial-class sign-ups a month from Instagram and Facebook by the end of the quarter	Leads from social (form, DM, WhatsApp)
Fill a restaurant on weekdays	Increase weekday reservations made via social media by 25% in 8 weeks	Bookings mentioning social / via link
Grow awareness for a new brand	Reach 60,000 people in Mauritius and gain 1,500 relevant followers in 3 months	Reach, followers in Mauritius
Better customer service	Reply to 95% of messages within 2 hours during opening hours	Response rate and time
B2B leads for a consultancy	8 qualified meetings a quarter from LinkedIn content and conversations	Meetings booked

Vanity metrics vs business metrics

Followers and likes are "vanity metrics": nice to see, but not proof of business value. Always connect social media to something that matters: enquiries, bookings, sales, sign-ups, customer satisfaction or recruitment.

SECTION 5

Choosing your platforms

It is better to be excellent on two or three platforms than mediocre on seven. Choose where your audience is, where your content type works and what you can maintain.

Business type	Main platforms	Supporting
Restaurant, café, bakery	Instagram, Facebook, WhatsApp	TikTok, Google Business Profile
Hotel, guesthouse, tour operator	Instagram, Facebook, YouTube	TikTok, Tripadvisor, Google Business Profile
Retail and fashion	Instagram, Facebook, TikTok	WhatsApp catalogue, Pinterest
Gym, salon, wellness	Instagram, Facebook, WhatsApp	TikTok, YouTube
B2B services, consulting, training	LinkedIn, Facebook	YouTube, WhatsApp, email
Real estate, car dealers	Facebook, Instagram, YouTube	TikTok, WhatsApp
NGO, community organisation	Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp	LinkedIn, YouTube
Recruitment / employer brand	LinkedIn, Facebook	Instagram, TikTok

Four questions to decide

1. **Is my audience there**, in Mauritius, in meaningful numbers? Check platform data and ask customers.
2. **Does my content fit the platform?** TikTok needs video and personality; LinkedIn needs expertise; Instagram needs strong visuals.
3. **Can I keep it up** for at least 6 months with my time and team?
4. **Does it support my goal?** Awareness, community, leads, service or recruitment.

Mini playbooks by industry

Industry	Priorities on social media	Content that works	Conversion path
Restaurants and cafés	Instagram and Facebook visuals, Google Business Profile photos, fast replies	Dishes being made, daily specials in stories, chef videos, customer moments, menu highlights	Reserve or order on WhatsApp; delivery app links
Hotels and guesthouses	Instagram, Facebook, YouTube; reviews on Tripadvisor and Google	Room tours, sunrise/sunset, local guides, staff, guest stories, multilingual captions	Direct-booking link with a clear benefit
Retail and fashion	Instagram, TikTok, Facebook, WhatsApp catalogue	New arrivals, try-ons, styling tips, behind-the-scenes, limited drops	Product tags, catalogue, WhatsApp orders, store visit
Beauty, wellness, gyms	Instagram, Facebook, TikTok	Before/after (with consent), tutorials, coach tips, transformations, booking slots	Book now button, WhatsApp, free trial
Professional services (B2B)	LinkedIn (people first), Facebook	Explainers of new rules, case studies, team expertise, events	Book a call, newsletter sign-up
Real estate and cars	Facebook, Instagram, YouTube	Video walkthroughs, area guides, financing explained, new arrivals	WhatsApp, visit booking, lead form
NGOs and causes	Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp	Impact stories, volunteers, events, transparent results	Volunteer sign-up, donations, events

Tip: reserve your brand name (handle) on the main platforms even if you won't use them yet, so nobody else takes it. Keep unused profiles private or clearly pointing to your main channels.

SECTION 6

The social media audit

A social media audit is a health check of all your accounts. It shows what works, what is broken and where the opportunities are. It is the first part of this week's deliverable.

Step by step

1. **List every account** the business has (search the name on each platform: old or duplicate pages are common).
2. **Check ownership and access:** who are the admins? Are they still with the company? Is two-factor authentication on?
3. **Check the profile** on each platform with the scorecard below.
4. **Collect performance data** for the last 90 days: followers, reach, engagement, top and bottom posts, response time.
5. **Analyse the content:** topics, formats, frequency, mix (Week 4 audit).
6. **Look at the community:** number and tone of comments, unanswered messages, reviews.
7. **Benchmark against 3 competitors** (Section 7).
8. **Write conclusions and actions:** keep, fix, start, stop.

Profile scorecard (score each line 0, 1 or 2)

Item	What "2" looks like
Handle and name	Same handle everywhere; name includes what you do or where
Profile picture and cover	Clear logo or face; cover shows the offer or place; up to date
Bio / about	Who, what, where, why you; call to action; languages your customers use
Contact and link	WhatsApp, phone, website or booking link that works
Category and info	Correct category, address, hours, service area
Highlights / pinned posts	Prices, reviews, FAQ, how to order
Posting consistency	Posts every week for the last 3 months
Content quality	Original photos and videos, readable on a phone, on-brand
Engagement	Real comments and shares; the brand replies
Response time	Messages answered within a few hours
Reviews / recommendations	Recent positive reviews, negative ones answered
Security	At least 2 admins from the business, 2FA on, Business portfolio used

Total out of 24: 0-10 = urgent work, 11-17 = good base, 18-24 = strong. Score each platform separately.

SECTION 7

Benchmarking and social listening

Benchmarking compares you with competitors. Social listening tracks what people say about your brand, your competitors and your topics. Both give you ideas and warnings for free.

Competitive benchmark table

Metric	You	Competitor A	Competitor B	Competitor C
Followers (Facebook / Instagram)				
Posts per week				
Main formats				
Average engagement per post				
Best-performing topic				
Response to comments (yes / no / slow)				
Running ads? (Meta Ad Library)				
What they do better than us				

Social listening on a small budget

- **Search your brand name** (and common misspellings) on Facebook, Instagram, TikTok and Google every week.
- **Follow local groups** where your customers talk (community, parenting, food, business groups) and read what they ask and complain about.
- **Set Google Alerts** ([google.com/alerts](https://www.google.com/alerts)) for your brand, competitors and topics.

- **Check mentions and tags** in your notifications and reply.
- **Use platform search** on TikTok and Instagram for your category to see trending content.
- **Paid tools** (Sprout Social, Hootsuite, Brandwatch, Talkwalker) automate listening at scale; useful for bigger brands.

Tip: keep a "listening log": date, where, what was said, sentiment, action taken. Over a few months it shows patterns: recurring complaints, questions and content ideas.

SECTION 8

Optimising your profiles

Your profile is the first thing people check after seeing a post. In a few seconds it must tell them who you are, what you offer, why you and how to contact you.

Anatomy of a profile that converts

Your profile is your shop front: people decide in seconds

NAME & HANDLE Easy to find Same handle everywhere; add the main keyword to the name field. @lakazgato · Lakaz Gato Cakes Rose Hill	PICTURE Recognisable Logo or face, readable at small size. Same image on every platform	BIO What, for whom, why you One line of value, one line of proof, one call to action. "Custom cakes · Delivered in Plaines Wilhems"
LINK & BUTTONS One click to act WhatsApp, booking, call, directions; a link page if needed. wa.me link, Book now	HIGHLIGHTS / PINS Answer the basics Prices, menu, reviews, FAQ, how to order. Pinned "Start here" post	PROOF Show it works Reviews, customer photos, results, media mentions. Highlight "Happy customers"

Bio formulas that work

Formula	Example
What + where + CTA	Custom celebration cakes in Rose Hill · Delivery across Plaines Wilhems · Order on WhatsApp ↓
Benefit + proof + CTA	Get fit in 30-minute classes · 1,200 members since 2019 · Free trial class ↓
Who you help + how	Helping Mauritian SMEs with tax, VAT and payroll · Free 20-min consultation ↓

Business accounts and verification

- Use **business or professional accounts** (Facebook Page, Instagram professional account, TikTok Business, LinkedIn Page). They give insights, contact buttons and access to ads.
- Link Facebook and Instagram in **Meta Business Suite**; manage them from one place.
- **Verification** (blue badge) is available through paid subscriptions such as Meta Verified for businesses; it can help trust and protection against impersonation but is optional for most small businesses.

- Use the same **contact details** as on your website and Google Business Profile (NAP consistency, Week 3).

Link in bio

Instagram and TikTok allow limited links. Use a WhatsApp click-to-chat link (wa.me/230XXXXXXX) or a simple link page (Linktree, Beacons or a page on your own website) with 3-5 clear options: order, book, menu, location, latest offer. Add UTM tags (Week 2) to see the traffic in GA4.

PART C

Platform playbooks

Facebook, Instagram, TikTok,
LinkedIn, YouTube, WhatsApp
and the rest

Facebook

Facebook is the most widely used social platform in Mauritius, reaching about seven in ten people. It is strongest for local communities, events, families and audiences over 30, and it is the base for Meta advertising (Week 8).

Set up properly

1. Create a **Facebook Page** (not a personal profile) from your personal account; you remain hidden as the admin.
2. Choose the right **category**, add address, hours, phone, WhatsApp, website and service area.
3. Add a recognisable profile picture (logo) and a cover image or short cover video showing your offer.
4. Write the **intro** in the language(s) your customers use, with a call to action.
5. Add an **action button**: Send WhatsApp message, Book now, Call or Shop.
6. Connect the Page to **Meta Business Suite** and to your **business portfolio** (formerly Business Manager) with at least two admins.

What works on Facebook in 2026

Format	Why it works	Tip
Reels	One of the strongest drivers of organic reach; shown to non-followers	Vertical, subtitled, under 60 seconds to start
Photo albums and carousels	Good for events, new collections, before/after	Strong first image; captions on each photo
Community posts and questions	Real conversations are rewarded	Ask genuine questions, not engagement bait
Events	Appear in people's event lists and reminders	Create an event for workshops, launches, live music
Live video	Notifications to followers; real-time comments	Announce in advance; keep the replay
Groups	High engagement and loyalty	Run a group around a shared interest (Section 20)
Link posts	Useful to send traffic, but usually less reach	Put the main value in the post; add the link in the text or first comment and test

Messenger and the inbox

Messages from Facebook and Instagram (and WhatsApp, where connected) can be managed in the Meta Business Suite inbox: labels, saved replies, automated FAQs and away messages. Turn on instant replies for common questions (prices, hours, delivery), but make sure a human follows up.

Tip: Facebook shows a "very responsive" badge on Pages that reply to most messages quickly. Fast replies also mean more sales: people often message several businesses and buy from the first that answers well.

Instagram

Instagram is a visual platform used by about a third of Mauritians, with a younger and more urban audience. It is strong for food, fashion, beauty, tourism, events, lifestyle and personal brands.

The main formats

Format	Role	Best practice
Reels	Reach new people (recommended to non-followers); Reels up to 3 minutes can appear in Explore	Hook in 3 seconds, original footage, subtitles, trending or library audio
Carousels (up to 20 slides)	Teach and inspire; high saves and shares	Slide 1 = promise; one idea per slide; CTA on the last slide
Stories	Daily connection with existing followers	Polls, questions, quizzes, links, countdowns; 3–7 frames a day
Highlights	Permanent menu on your profile	Prices, menu, reviews, FAQ, how to order, location
Collab posts	One post published on two accounts	Partner with suppliers, venues, creators
Broadcast channels	One-to-many messages to your most loyal followers	Exclusive news, early offers, behind-the-scenes
Live	Q&A, launches, tutorials	Invite a guest; save and share the replay

What Instagram rewards

- **Originality:** in 2026 Instagram said it favours original photos and videos over reposts and re-uploads; content with another app's watermark is shown less.
- **Sends (shares by DM):** one of the strongest signals that a post deserves more reach.
- **Watch time and saves** for Reels and carousels.
- **Trial Reels:** test a Reel with non-followers first, then share it with followers if it performs well.

Create a Reel step by step

1. Plan the hook, 3–5 shots and the CTA (use the Week 4 video template).
2. Film vertically in good light; record a few extra seconds before and after each shot.
3. In Instagram (or the Edits app or CapCut), import clips, trim each to 2–3 seconds and order them.
4. Add on-screen text for the hook and key points, and auto-captions; check spelling.
5. Choose audio from the platform's library; keep the volume of voice clear.
6. Pick a cover frame that is readable in your profile grid.
7. Write a caption with keywords and one CTA; tag partners or use a Collab post.
8. Consider Trial Reels for experiments; reply to comments in the first hour after posting.

Instagram as a search engine

People search Instagram for places, products and ideas. Use clear keywords in your name field, bio, captions and alt text ("birthday cake Rose Hill", "brunch Grand Baie"). Since 2025, public posts from professional accounts can also appear in Google search results, which makes good captions even more valuable.

In Mauritius: add your town or area to your name field and captions. Many local searches on Instagram include a place name.

SECTION 11

TikTok

TikTok is an entertainment and discovery platform built on short vertical video. Its algorithm shows content based on interests rather than who you follow, so even a new account with few followers can reach thousands of people with one good video.

Getting started

- Create a **TikTok Business account**: free, with analytics, a website link and access to the Commercial Music Library (music cleared for business use).
- Watch TikTok in your category for a week before posting: note the formats, sounds and humour that work.
- Post consistently (2–4 times a week if TikTok is a priority).
- Reply to comments with video replies: they often become your best content.

Content that works on TikTok

Type	Example
Behind the scenes	Packing orders, preparing a dish, the morning rush
Tutorial in 30 seconds	"How to fold a sari pleat", "How to clean car seats"
Trend with a local twist	A popular sound or format adapted in Kreol to your business
Storytime	The owner tells a funny or emotional customer story
Myths and facts	A mechanic, a nutritionist or an accountant busts common myths
Series	"Rating every dholl puri in Rose Hill", part 1, 2, 3...

TikTok rules of thumb

- Authentic beats polished: phone video and real people perform well.
- The first second must create curiosity; text on screen helps.
- Completion rate and rewatches matter: keep it tight.
- Use keywords in on-screen text, captions and spoken words; TikTok search is widely used.
- Only use sounds from the Commercial Music Library on business accounts.

TikTok has a younger audience. Respect advertising rules for age-restricted products (alcohol, gambling) and be especially careful with content involving children.

LinkedIn

LinkedIn is the professional network: about 630,000 members in Mauritius, growing fast. It is the key platform for B2B sales, recruitment, training and consulting, and for building personal expertise.

Company Page vs personal profiles

	Company Page	Personal profiles (founder, team)
Reach	Usually lower	Usually much higher; people trust people
Best for	Official news, jobs, culture, credibility	Expertise, opinions, stories, relationships
Strategy	Post 2–3 times a week; ask employees to engage	Founders and experts post regularly; the Page reshares

What the algorithm rewards

- **Dwell time:** how long people stop on your post. Strong first lines and useful detail help.
- **Real conversations in comments**, especially from people in your field. Ask a genuine question at the end.
- **Topic consistency:** posting regularly about a clear area of expertise beats random topics.
- **Native formats:** document posts (PDF carousels), native video and text posts with a strong hook often outperform posts with outbound links.
- **Original insight:** generic, AI-sounding posts perform poorly; personal experience and data perform well.

Company Page set-up checklist

- ☐ Logo, cover image and a tagline that says what you do and for whom
- ☐ About section with keywords, location, website, industry and company size
- ☐ Custom button (Visit website, Contact us, Register)
- ☐ Ask all employees to add the company to their profile (it links them to the Page)
- ☐ Post a "Featured" or pinned introduction post; invite connections to follow

LinkedIn content ideas for Mauritian businesses

Lessons from a recent project, a client success story (with permission), an explanation of a new regulation or budget measure, a team member spotlight, a short guide as a PDF carousel, an event recap, an open job with a real description of the culture.

Tip: put outbound links in moderation: many experts place the link in the first comment or at the end, and give the main value in the post itself.

SECTION 13

YouTube

YouTube is the world's largest video platform and the second most used search engine. It is ideal for tutorials, reviews, longer stories and evergreen content that keeps getting views for years.

Element	Best practice
Channel	Brand name, clear banner, "About" with keywords and links, playlists by topic
Title	Main keyword + benefit: "How to prepare your house for cyclone season (Mauritius checklist)"
Thumbnail	A face or a clear object, 3-5 words of large text, high contrast
Description	First 2 lines summarise; add links, chapters (timestamps) and keywords
Shorts	Vertical videos up to 3 minutes; great for discovery; link to a long video
Engagement	Ask for comments, reply, pin a helpful comment

YouTube results also appear in Google search, so a good video can bring visitors from both platforms. Embed your videos on your website pages too (Week 3).

SECTION 14

WhatsApp for business

WhatsApp is where most Mauritian customer conversations end: questions, quotes, orders, delivery updates. Used well, it is a powerful sales and service channel; used badly, it becomes spam.

WhatsApp Business app (free)

Feature	Use it for
Business profile	Address, hours, website, description, category
Catalogue	Products or services with photos and prices, shareable as a link
Quick replies	Saved answers to frequent questions (type "/" to insert)
Greeting and away messages	Automatic welcome and out-of-hours replies
Labels	Organise chats: new lead, order paid, delivered, follow up
Status	24-hour updates to your contacts: today's specials, new stock
Channels	One-way updates to people who choose to follow you
Broadcast lists	One message to many contacts (only those who saved your number receive it)
Click-to-chat link and QR code	wa.me/230XXXXXXX on your bio, posts, packaging and in-store

WhatsApp Business Platform (API)

Larger businesses use the WhatsApp Business Platform through a provider to connect several agents, a CRM and automated flows (order confirmations, appointment reminders). Business-initiated messages on the Platform are charged by Meta and must use approved templates.

Consent first: only message people who gave you their number for that purpose, make it easy to stop messages, and don't add people to groups without asking. Spam leads to blocks and reports, and Meta can restrict your number.

SECTION 15

Other platforms worth knowing

These platforms are smaller in Mauritius or more specialised, but can be valuable for some businesses.

Platform	What it is	Consider it if...
Threads	Meta's text-based conversation app, linked to Instagram	You have a strong voice and want conversation with Instagram followers
X (Twitter)	Real-time news and opinion; about 210,000 ad reach in Mauritius	You are in media, politics, tech or need real-time updates
Pinterest	Visual search and inspiration boards	You sell decor, weddings, fashion, recipes or travel to international audiences
Snapchat	Messaging and short stories, popular with teenagers	Your audience is very young
Google Business Profile	Your listing on Google Search and Maps, with posts and photos	You have a physical location or local service (every local business)
Tripadvisor, Booking.com	Review and booking platforms	You are in tourism and hospitality

PART D

Growth & community

Organic best practices, community
management, service and crises

Organic growth: best practices

Organic reach is harder than it was ten years ago, but businesses that post useful, original content consistently and engage with their community still grow without paying for every view.

The ten habits of accounts that grow

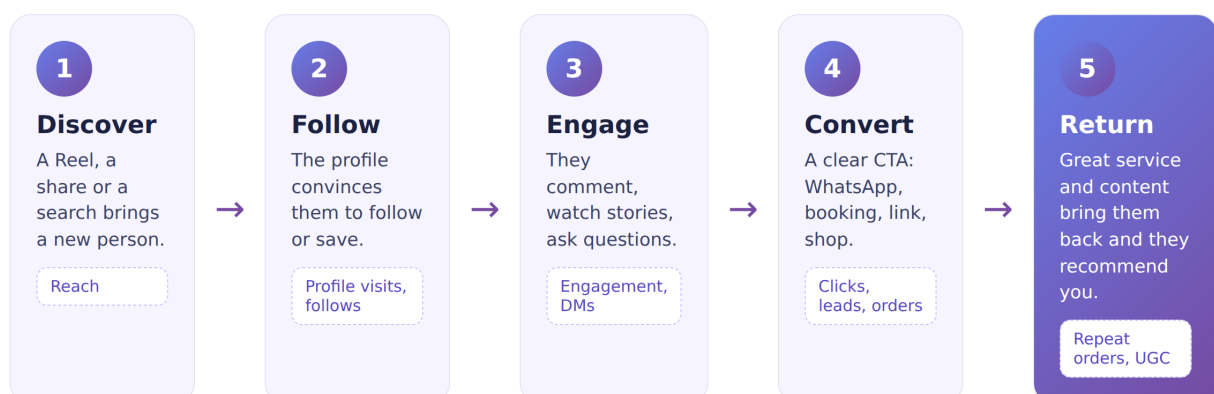
1. **Consistency:** a realistic rhythm kept for months (e.g. 3 posts + stories a week).
2. **Video first for discovery:** at least 1-2 short videos a week on Instagram, Facebook and TikTok.
3. **Strong hooks:** the first line and first 3 seconds decide everything.
4. **Original content:** your own photos and videos, your people, your place.
5. **Shareable value:** tips, local guides and relatable moments people send to friends.
6. **Engage before and after posting:** reply to every comment in the first hour; comment on other local accounts.
7. **Collaborations:** Collab posts, partner brands, local creators, guest appearances.
8. **Keywords, not hashtag lists:** 3-5 relevant hashtags plus clear keywords in captions and on-screen text.
9. **Cross-promotion:** QR codes in-store, social links on receipts, email signature, website, packaging.
10. **Learn from data:** do more of what your insights say works.

Your social media routine

When	Tasks	Time
Every day	Check and reply to comments and messages (morning, lunch, evening); post stories; engage with 5-10 local accounts	20-40 min
Every week	Plan and batch next week's posts; schedule; review last week's top posts; collect photos and ideas	2-3 hours
Every month	Monthly report; update the content calendar; audit profiles and links; refresh highlights	2-3 hours
Every quarter	Review objectives and platforms; competitor benchmark; update the playbook	Half a day

From follower to customer

Organic social media can bring sales if you build the path



Hashtags in 2026

Hashtags still help platforms categorise content, but they matter less than keywords and engagement. Use a few relevant ones (#mauritius, #ilemaurice, your town, your niche, a branded hashtag) rather than 30 generic tags. Avoid banned or spammy hashtags.

Growing followers the right way

Running a giveaway properly

1. Set a goal (e.g. new local followers interested in your product, or user-generated content).
 2. Choose a prize your real customers want (a product or voucher), not a generic phone.
 3. Write clear rules: dates, who can enter (e.g. residents of Mauritius, 18+), how to enter, how the winner is chosen and announced.
 4. Follow the platform's promotion rules: for example, Facebook doesn't allow asking people to share on their own timeline or tag friends on their timeline to enter.
 5. State that the promotion is not sponsored or endorsed by the platform.
 6. Pick the winner fairly (random draw tool), announce publicly and deliver quickly.
- Never buy followers or engagement: fake accounts kill your engagement rate and break platform rules.
 - Avoid "follow/unfollow" tactics and engagement pods.
 - Run giveaways carefully: they attract prize hunters. Make the prize relevant to your real customers, follow the platform's promotion rules and announce winners transparently.
 - Invite existing customers (in-store, WhatsApp, email) to follow: they are your most valuable followers.

SECTION 17

Community management

Community management means listening and responding to people on your social accounts: comments, messages, mentions, reviews and group discussions. It turns followers into fans and fans into customers.

How to respond to comments and messages

First read and sort, then respond by type

PRAISE Thank and personalise Use their name, mention what they liked, invite a review or share. Within the day	QUESTION Answer clearly Reply publicly if useful to others; move personal details to DM. Within 1-2 hours	COMPLAINT Acknowledge and fix Apologise, take it private, solve it, follow up publicly. As fast as possible	SPAM / ABUSE Protect the community Hide or delete spam, ban abusers, never argue. Apply your house rules
---	--	--	---

Golden rules

- **Reply to everyone** who takes the time to comment, even with a short personalised answer.
- **Be fast:** aim for a few hours during opening hours, and set an away message outside them.
- **Use their name and their language** (English, French or Kreol).
- **Stay on brand:** warm, helpful, never defensive.

- **Move private matters to private messages** (orders, phone numbers, complaints with personal details).
- **Like and pin** great comments; turn frequent questions into content.
- **Never delete criticism** just because it is negative. Hide only spam, insults, personal data or illegal content.

Moderation tools you should switch on

- **Facebook:** Page moderation settings let you block comments containing chosen words and filter profanity automatically.
- **Instagram:** "Hidden words" filters offensive comments and message requests; you can add your own words (e.g. spam phrases).
- **TikTok and YouTube:** keyword filters and the option to hold comments for review.
- **All platforms:** restrict, block or report accounts that harass; report impersonation of your brand.

House rules

Publish simple community rules on your Page or group (and pin them): be respectful, no spam or self-promotion, no hate speech or discrimination, no personal data in comments, we may hide or remove comments that break these rules. Rules make moderation fair and transparent.

Saved replies library (examples)

Situation	Saved reply (adapt each time)
Price question	"Hi [name]! Our celebration cakes start at Rs 1,800 for 1 kg. Can you tell us the date and number of guests? We'll send options on WhatsApp: wa.me/230..."
Delivery area	"Yes [name], we deliver across Plaines Wilhems and Port Louis; other areas on request. What's your location?"
Compliment	"Thank you so much [name]! It was a pleasure to bake for your family. Would you mind sharing a quick Google review? [link]"
Out of stock	"Sorry [name], it's sold out this week. It's back on Friday: shall we reserve one for you?"

SECTION 18

Customer service on social media

Customers increasingly ask questions and complain through social media and WhatsApp rather than by phone or email. Treat these channels as a real customer service desk.

Set up a simple process

1. **One inbox:** manage Facebook, Instagram and WhatsApp messages from Meta Business Suite or a single tool.
2. **Clear owner and hours:** who answers, when, and who covers holidays.
3. **Response targets:** e.g. first reply within 2 hours during opening hours; complaints escalated the same day.
4. **Labels:** new lead, order, complaint, resolved, follow up.
5. **Escalation:** refunds, safety issues and angry customers go to the manager.
6. **Close the loop:** confirm the problem is solved and thank the customer.

Measure service quality

KPI	How
Response rate	Messages answered ÷ messages received
Average first response time	Shown in Meta Business Suite and most tools
Resolution rate	Issues solved ÷ issues raised
Sentiment	Share of positive, neutral and negative comments each month

Tip: save time with automated FAQs in Meta Business Suite (instant replies to "Prices?", "Opening hours?", "Location?"), but always offer a way to reach a human.

SECTION 19

Negative comments and crisis management

Every business receives criticism. Handled well, a complaint can increase trust, because other customers see how you treat people. Handled badly, it can become a crisis that spreads fast in a small market.

How to reply to a negative comment

1. **Pause** and don't reply emotionally. Check the facts (order details, staff on duty).
2. **Reply publicly and quickly:** thank, apologise for the experience, show you take it seriously.
3. **Take it private** for details: "We've sent you a message to sort this out."
4. **Fix the problem** and, where appropriate, offer a fair solution.
5. **Follow up publicly** once resolved ("Thank you for your patience, glad we could fix it.").
6. **Learn:** if the same complaint appears often, fix the cause.

Replying to reviews on Google, Facebook and Tripadvisor

Reviews are public and long-lasting, so treat them like comments: thank every reviewer, use their name, mention something specific, and answer negative reviews with the same calm, factual approach. Never offer rewards in exchange for positive reviews (Week 3).

Bad reply	Good reply
"That's not true, our cakes are always fresh."	"We're really sorry to hear this, [name]. Freshness matters a lot to us. Could you message us your order number? We'd like to understand what happened and make it right."
Deleting the comment	Replying calmly so other customers see you care
Arguing in several long replies	One short public reply, then private conversation

Crisis levels: how big is the problem?

Match the response to the risk

LEVEL 1 • ISSUE

One unhappy customer

Normal complaint. Reply with care and fix it.

Community manager

LEVEL 2 • SPREADING

Several complaints or a viral post

Same problem repeated, shared in groups.

Manager decides within hours

LEVEL 3 • CRISIS

Safety, legal or reputational risk

Media interest, health or safety issue, serious accusation.

Owner + crisis plan, pause scheduled posts

A simple crisis plan

- ☐ Who decides (owner or manager) and who speaks for the business
- ☐ Pause all scheduled posts and ads during a serious crisis
- ☐ Gather facts before making statements; don't guess or blame
- ☐ Respond publicly on social media first, quickly and honestly, then update as you learn more
- ☐ Use one holding statement for all channels: "We're aware of... We're looking into it... We'll update by..."
- ☐ Keep records (screenshots) and seek legal advice when needed
- ☐ After the crisis: explain what changed and thank people for their patience

Why speed matters: in a 2026 Sprout Social survey of 2,250 social media users (US, UK and Australia), 84% said a brand's response speed affects how they see a crisis, and 64% said brands should respond publicly on social media rather than only through a press release.

SECTION 20

Groups and communities

Groups create stronger bonds than Pages because members talk to each other, not just to the brand.

Type	Example	Tips
Facebook group	"Running in the North - Mauritius" run by a sports shop	Clear purpose, rules, weekly prompts, events; brand stays in the background
WhatsApp Community	Parents' community of a school or academy, with sub-groups	Announcements group plus topic groups; admins only for announcements
Instagram broadcast channel	Bakery's "first to know" channel for new flavours	Exclusive and short; 1-3 messages a week
LinkedIn group / newsletter	Accounting firm's "SME finance tips"	Expert value, not sales pitches

Participating in other groups

Local Facebook groups (community, buy-and-sell, parenting, food lovers, expat groups) are where many Mauritians ask for recommendations. Join as your business (if allowed) or as yourself, follow the rules, answer questions helpfully and only mention your business when it is genuinely relevant.

SECTION 21

Creators, collaborations and employee advocacy

People trust people. Collaborating with local creators, partner businesses and your own team multiplies your reach and credibility.

Approach	How it works	Example
Collab posts	One post on two accounts with shared reach	A guesthouse and a snorkelling guide
Creator partnership	A local creator makes content about you (paid or gifted, always disclosed)	A food creator reviews your new menu
Takeovers	A partner or team member runs your stories for a day	"A day with our head chef"
Employee advocacy	Team members share and create content on their own profiles	Engineers sharing project milestones on LinkedIn
UGC	Customers share their experience; you repost with permission	#LagonBleuMoments

Paid or gifted content must be clearly disclosed with the platform's "Paid partnership" label or #ad. Give employees simple guidelines (what they can share, what stays confidential) and never force them to post.

SECTION 22

From social media to sales

Organic social media can generate leads and sales directly when you make it easy to take the next step.

Tool	Use
WhatsApp button and links	The main conversion path in Mauritius: "Order on WhatsApp"
Facebook and Instagram shops / product tags	Show products with prices in posts (availability depends on country and eligibility)
WhatsApp catalogue	Share products and prices in chat
Link in bio page	Order, book, menu, latest offer, with UTM tags
Booking buttons	Book now on Facebook and Instagram linked to your booking system
Stories link sticker	Send followers straight to a page or form
DM keyword automations	"Comment MENU to receive our menu by message" (with tools like ManyChat; Week 15)

Track it

Use UTM-tagged links (Week 2) so GA4 shows sessions and conversions from each platform, label WhatsApp chats by source, and ask new customers how they found you. Without tracking, social media looks like a cost; with tracking, you can prove its value.

PART E

Tools, data & governance

Scheduling, analytics, reporting,
security and a first look at ads

SECTION 23

Scheduling and management tools

Tools save time, keep a consistent rhythm and give a team one place to work.

Tool	Cost	Good for
Meta Business Suite	Free	Schedule Facebook and Instagram posts, stories and reels; inbox; insights
TikTok, LinkedIn, YouTube native schedulers	Free	Scheduling directly on each platform
Buffer	Free plan + paid	Simple multi-platform scheduling for small teams
Hootsuite	Paid	Teams, listening, approvals, reporting
Later	Paid (trial)	Visual planning for Instagram and TikTok
Canva Content Planner	Paid plans	Design and schedule in one place
Metricool	Free plan + paid	Scheduling and analytics across platforms

Tip: schedule posts, but don't schedule and disappear. Be online after a post goes live to reply to the first comments.

SECTION 24

Social media analytics

Each platform gives free insights. Learn where to find them and which numbers to track for your objectives.

Metric	What it tells you	Where
Reach	How many unique people saw your content	All platforms
Views / impressions	How many times content was displayed or played	All platforms
Engagement rate	Share of people who interacted	Calculate: $\text{interactions} \div \text{reach} \times 100$
Shares and saves	How valuable people found it	Post insights
Average watch time, retention	Whether the video kept attention	Reels, TikTok, YouTube analytics
Profile visits, link clicks	Interest in your business	Account insights
Follower growth and demographics	Who your audience is and if it grows	Audience tab
Messages and response time	Service quality and leads	Meta Business Suite inbox
Sessions and conversions from social	Real business impact	GA4 with UTM tags

Where to find your insights

Platform	Where	Tip
Facebook and Instagram	Meta Business Suite → Insights (results, content, audience); or Professional dashboard in the Instagram app	Export content data monthly for your report
TikTok	Profile → menu → Business Suite / Analytics (overview, content, followers)	Look at average watch time and traffic sources
LinkedIn	Page → Analytics (visitors, followers, content); post analytics on personal posts	Check who engages: job titles and companies
YouTube	YouTube Studio → Analytics (reach, engagement, audience)	Watch the retention graph to see where viewers leave
Website impact	GA4 → Reports → Acquisition → Traffic acquisition (session source/medium)	UTM-tag every social link (Week 2)

Benchmarks: compare with yourself

Published "average engagement rates" vary a lot by industry, country, account size and calculation method. The most useful benchmark is your own: compare each month with the previous months and with your direct local competitors.

Key formulas

Metric	Formula
Engagement rate by reach	$(\text{reactions} + \text{comments} + \text{shares} + \text{saves}) \div \text{reach} \times 100$
Follower growth rate	$\text{new followers} \div \text{followers at start of period} \times 100$
Click-through rate	$\text{link clicks} \div \text{impressions} \times 100$
Response rate	$\text{messages answered} \div \text{messages received} \times 100$
Share of voice	$\text{your brand mentions} \div \text{total mentions of you and competitors} \times 100$

SECTION 25

Monthly social media report

A one-page monthly report keeps everyone focused on results, not activity.

Section	Content
1. Summary	Three sentences: what improved, what didn't, why
2. Objectives	Each SMART objective: target, actual, on track or not
3. Platform numbers	Reach, engagement rate, followers, clicks, messages per platform vs last month
4. Best and worst content	Top 3 and bottom 3 posts with the reason
5. Community and service	Response rate and time, sentiment, notable comments or issues
6. Business impact	Leads, bookings, sales from social (GA4, WhatsApp labels, customer survey)
7. Next month	3 actions with owner and date

Week 18 (performance reporting and data storytelling) shows how to turn reports into dashboards and presentations.

SECTION 26

Governance, security and policies

Many Mauritian businesses have lost their pages to hackers or former employees. A few simple rules protect your accounts and your reputation.

Security checklist

- ☐ Pages and ad accounts owned by a Meta business portfolio (Business Manager) in the company's name
- ☐ At least two trusted admins from the business; agencies and freelancers get partner access, not ownership
- ☐ Two-factor authentication on every admin account (authenticator app preferred)
- ☐ Strong unique passwords stored in a password manager, never shared by WhatsApp
- ☐ Remove access immediately when someone leaves
- ☐ Beware of fake "Meta support" or "copyright violation" messages: they are phishing
- ☐ Login emails and recovery phone numbers that belong to the business, not one employee

Social media policy (one page)

Topic	What to define
Roles	Who posts, who approves, who replies, who handles crises
Brand rules	Voice, visuals, languages, topics to avoid (politics, religion debates)
Response rules	Response times, escalation, what can be said publicly
Employees	What staff may share about work; confidentiality; personal opinions
Legal	Copyright, consent for photos, data protection (Data Protection Act 2017), disclosures, competitions
Crisis	The crisis plan from Section 19

SECTION 27

A first look at paid social

Organic and paid social work together. This week focuses on organic; Weeks 8 and 9 cover ads in depth. Here is what you need to know now.

	Boost post	Ads Manager campaign
What it is	Promote an existing post with a few clicks	Full campaign with objectives, audiences, placements, creatives
Good for	Giving a successful organic post more reach	Leads, sales, traffic, app installs, retargeting
Control	Basic	Advanced: testing, budgets, tracking, optimisation
Learn in	This week (basics)	Week 8 (Meta Ads)

A smart starting approach

- Let posts run organically for 2–3 days, then boost only the ones that already perform well.
- Target people in Mauritius (or your tourist markets) with relevant interests, or your existing followers and their friends.

- Start small (for example Rs 1,000–3,000 for 5–7 days) and compare cost per result.
- Install the Meta Pixel on your website (Week 2 and Week 8) so ads can be measured and optimised.

PART F

Put it to work

A case study, your Social
Playbook, templates and checklists

Case study: a gym's social media turnaround

"FitZone" is a fictional but realistic gym in Quatre Bornes with 600 members. Its Facebook Page and Instagram account had 3,000 and 1,800 followers but almost no engagement, and the owner felt social media "doesn't work".

1. The audit (score: 9/24)

- Two Facebook Pages (an old one created by a former trainer, still visible and outdated).
- Instagram bio: "Welcome to FitZone" with no location, no prices and a broken link.
- Posts: mostly promotional flyers, 1-2 a month, with long text in images.
- 23 unanswered Messenger and Instagram messages, some asking for prices.
- Only one admin (the former manager) on the main Facebook Page.

2. Quick fixes (week 1)

- Recovered admin access, added the owner and manager as admins in a business portfolio, turned on 2FA.
- Merged and closed the old Page; same handle @fitzone.qb on Facebook, Instagram and TikTok.
- New bio: "Gym & group classes in Quatre Bornes · From Rs 1,500/month · Free trial class ↓" with a WhatsApp link.
- Highlights: Prices, Timetable, Trial class, Transformations, Location.
- Replied to every pending message and set instant replies for prices and hours.

3. Strategy

Element	Decision
Objective	40 trial-class sign-ups a month from social media within 3 months
Audience	Beginners 25-45 in Plaines Wilhems, especially women who feel intimidated by gyms
Platforms	Instagram and Facebook (main), WhatsApp (conversion), TikTok (test for 8 weeks)
Pillars	Beginner tips · Real member stories · Coaches and classes · Healthy Mauritian food · Challenges and events
Rhythm	3 Reels + 1 carousel a week, daily stories, 1 live Q&A a month
Community	Reply within 2 hours (7:00-21:00), weekly comment prompts, member spotlight every Friday

4. Results after 12 weeks (illustrative)

KPI	Before	After 12 weeks
Average reach per post (Instagram)	420	2,900
Engagement rate by reach	1.2%	5.8%
Messages per month	35	160
Average first response time	2 days	1 h 20 min
Trial-class sign-ups from social	About 8	46
New memberships from trials	About 3	19

What made the difference: coaches talking to camera ("3 exercises if you're scared of the gym"), member stories, fast WhatsApp replies and a clear free-trial offer in every bio and caption. TikTok brought views but few local leads, so it was kept as a secondary channel.

The lesson: social media "worked" as soon as the basics were fixed (profiles, access, replies) and content was built around the audience's real fears and questions.

SECTION 29

Exercises and your Social Playbook

Your Week 5 deliverable is a **Social Playbook**: a social media audit plus a 2-week content plan for 2 platforms. Work on a real business: your own, your employer's or one you know well.

Exercise A · Social media audit (60 min)

Use the 8 steps in Section 6 and the 12-line profile scorecard for each platform. Add the 90-day performance numbers, the top 3 and bottom 3 posts, and the number of unanswered messages or comments you can see.

Exercise B · Competitor benchmark (30 min)

Fill in the benchmark table in Section 7 for the business and 3 competitors. Check the Meta Ad Library for each. Write 3 things competitors do better and 3 opportunities.

Exercise C · Profile makeover (30 min)

Rewrite the bio for each main platform using a formula from Section 8, choose 5 highlights or pinned posts, and fix any broken link. Show before/after screenshots.

Exercise D · Two-week content plan for 2 platforms (60 min)

Using your Week 4 pillars, plan 14 days for 2 platforms: date, platform, pillar, format, hook, caption summary, CTA. Include at least 4 short videos, 2 carousels, daily story ideas and one community post (question or poll).

Exercise E · Community and service rules (30 min)

Write house rules, 6 saved replies (price, delivery, compliment, complaint, out of stock, out of hours) and a 5-line crisis plan.

Deliverable: the Social Playbook

Part	Content
1. Business and objectives	Summary and 2–3 SMART social media objectives
2. Audit	Scorecards, 90-day numbers, key findings
3. Benchmark	Competitor table and opportunities
4. Platform choice	Main and supporting platforms, with reasons
5. Profiles	Optimised bios, highlights, links (before/after)
6. Two-week content plan	2 platforms, 14 days (link to Google Sheet)
7. Community management	House rules, saved replies, response targets, crisis plan
8. Measurement	KPIs per objective, tools, monthly report template

Submit the playbook (Google Doc or PDF link, 6–10 pages) and your content plan on the learning platform, Module 5 exercises.

Copy-and-use templates

Two-week content plan

Day	Platform	Pillar	Format	Hook / topic	CTA
Mon 1					
Tue 2					
Wed 3					
Thu 4					
Fri 5					
Sat 6					
Sun 7					
Mon 8					
Tue 9					
Wed 10					
Thu 11					
Fri 12					
Sat 13					
Sun 14					

Response matrix

Type	Who replies	Target time	Public or private	Escalate to
Question				
Compliment				
Complaint				
Order / booking				
Spam / abuse				
Media or legal				

Checklists and glossary

Social media launch checklist

- ☐ SMART objectives linked to business goals
- ☐ 2-3 priority platforms chosen; others reserved or closed
- ☐ Business accounts, same handle, complete profiles, working links
- ☐ Business portfolio, 2+ admins, 2FA, password manager
- ☐ Pillars, formats and a realistic weekly rhythm
- ☐ Scheduling tool set up; first 2 weeks planned
- ☐ House rules, saved replies, response targets, away messages
- ☐ Crisis plan agreed
- ☐ UTM links and GA4 tracking; WhatsApp labels by source
- ☐ Monthly report date in the diary

Mistakes to avoid

Mistake	Do this instead
Being everywhere, badly	Focus on 2-3 platforms
Ignoring comments and messages	Reply fast and personally
Deleting criticism	Reply calmly and take it private
Engagement bait and bought followers	Genuine questions and real customers
Reposting videos with other apps' watermarks	Upload original files
One person holds all access	Business portfolio, 2+ admins, 2FA
Posting and disappearing	Stay online to reply after posting
Judging success by followers	Track leads, bookings and sales

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Algorithm	The system that decides which content each person sees and in which order
Organic / paid	Free content and reach / content promoted with advertising
Reach / impressions	Unique people who saw content / total times it was displayed
Engagement rate	Interactions as a percentage of reach (or impressions)
Community management	Listening and replying to comments, messages and mentions
Social listening	Tracking what people say about a brand, competitors and topics
Share of voice	Your share of all conversations in your category
Business portfolio	Meta's tool (formerly Business Manager) to own Pages, ad accounts and access
2FA	Two-factor authentication: a second step to log in
Collab post	An Instagram post published on two accounts at the same time
Broadcast channel	One-to-many messaging on Instagram or WhatsApp Channels
Trial Reels	Instagram feature to test a Reel with non-followers first
Commercial Music Library	TikTok's music cleared for business use
UGC	User-generated content created by customers
Employee advocacy	Employees sharing company content on their own profiles
Engagement bait	Posts that beg for likes, comments or tags; penalised by platforms
Boost	Promoting an existing post with a budget
Holding statement	A short first public response in a crisis while facts are checked